

What's Left — Plain-Language Summary

For: everyone who uses the MTM Waitlist system — operators, material handlers, supervisors, plant managers, and whoever administers the machine it runs on.

No technical background needed. This is the everyday-language companion to `OPEN-TASKS.md`, which is the same information written for the people who work in the code. If you want the technical detail, read that one.

Last updated: 11 September 2026.

The short version

The Waitlist app is in good shape. The big piece of recent work — a **spare copy of Infor Visual data** so the screens keep working when Infor Visual is unavailable — is built, running, and refreshing successfully.

Four things are still open. **Two of them need a decision from you**, one you can fix yourself in ten seconds, and one is a long-term measurement that just needs time to run.

Nothing here is broken in a way that stops you working today.

What's working right now

- **The app's own data is always live.** Waitlist requests, WIP, and Receiving are read and written straight to the database. Nothing is ever faked or substituted.
- **If Infor Visual goes down, the screens keep working.** The app quietly switches to a saved copy of that data, and switches back on its own when Infor Visual returns. There is no switch to remember and

nothing to

press.

- **The spare copy is now being kept up to date successfully.** All five sets of Infor Visual data refresh properly — this was broken and was fixed on 11 September.
- **The service that keeps the spare copy warm has a proper window again,** with Settings and Status pages laid out in the same style as the main app.

Things you may need to do

1. Show the service's tray icon (10 seconds, no tools needed)

The background service has **no ordinary window**. You reach it from a small icon near the clock.

Windows

hides brand-new tray icons by default, so that icon is currently tucked away — which makes a perfectly healthy service look like it isn't running.

To show it:

1. Click the small  arrow on the taskbar (next to the clock), **or**
2. Go to **Settings** → **Personalization** → **Taskbar** → **Other system tray icons** and switch on `MTM_Waitlist.Mock.Service`.

Then click the icon to open the service's **Status** page (is everything up to date?) and **Settings** page.

2. Decide how the service's password is handled

This one needs your decision, and it's currently blocking things.

The background service protects its status page — and lets other programs ask it to refresh — using a password. Right now that password is **created automatically, but there is no way to see it**. Not for you, not for IT, and not for the programs that need it.

The result: **nobody can check the service's status, and nothing can trigger a refresh on demand.**
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service is running fine — you just can't ask it anything.

Two options, either is fine:

- **Show it once when it's created** so the person setting up the machine can write it down, or
- **Let the operator type in the password** they want, and the service stores that.

Just say which you prefer.

Known problems, and what they mean for you

Cached work orders can be incomplete (partly fixed)

When Infor Visual is unavailable, work-order lookups are served from the saved copy. Two problems were found:

- **Fixed:** some lookups could show a **different work order's information** than the live system would.
Wrong data is worse than no data, so this mattered. Now a cached result either matches what the real system would return, or returns nothing.
- **Still open:** many work orders **can't be looked up at all**, because the app only accepts work-order numbers written in certain ways, and a large number of open orders use other formats. Fixing this means changing how the app accepts work-order numbers — which changes how people type them in.
That's a decision for you, not a quick repair.

If the service stops refreshing, nothing will tell you why

The service doesn't keep a log file. When something goes wrong, the reason is only visible to a developer attached to the running program — so a problem stays invisible until somebody notices the data is stale.

The plan is to give the service a proper log file, so this becomes diagnosable instead of invisible.

The full end-to-end test hasn't been run yet

The formal acceptance test — proving the fallback works with Infor Visual deliberately switched off, on a signed-in machine, plus the backup-and-restore drill — has **not** been completed. It needs a specific setup that isn't in place yet.

Separately, **two long-term measurements haven't started**, and they need **30 days of real time**:

- that at least **95% of scheduled refreshes** succeed, and
- that **every scheduled backup** produces a file that can actually be restored.

Because they need a month of wall-clock time, the sooner they're switched on the better. Nothing else is waiting on them.

What's planned next

These are the next pieces of work, roughly in the order they make sense. Each is a project in its own right.

What	What it gives you
Handlers can accept and finish jobs	Accept / Complete / Release actions on each request. Accepting assigns the job to you automatically, it stays on the shared list, and only you can complete or release it. Handlers can add a note, and the shared list is sorted most urgent first . <i>(The due-time and overdue maths are already done.)</i>
One consistent request card	Every request shows as the same simple two-line card — like "Deliver: Coil" — instead of a long list of type names. Creating a request becomes Category → Item (Pickup / Deliver / Assist / Other), and you're only offered items the job actually has.
Reporting for managers	A Plant Manager dashboard: volumes, how quickly requests get filled, on-time versus late, cancellations and reasons, workload per handler, and how often parts were short at the time of the request.

What	What it gives you
Cancellations and old-request housekeeping	An admin view of who cancelled what, when, and why. Finished requests older than 90 days drop off the main list but are kept, never deleted , so reporting stays complete.
User management	A new Administration area in Settings to add and edit users and their roles, search for them, and deactivate them — with protection against locking yourself out.
A clearer start-up message	If the main database can't be reached, show a plain message with Retry and Cancel instead of a technical error.

Things that are *not* being built

So nobody waits for them:

- **No request-type editor.** You won't get screens to add or change request types and subtypes. That was decided deliberately — the existing catalog is used as-is.
- **No "use test data" switch.** The fallback is **automatic** and always has been. There is no manual mode to switch on or off, and one won't be added. Where the app reads live data, it stays live.

If something looks wrong

1. **Check the service is running** — click the  arrow on the taskbar and look for `MTM_Waitlist.Mock.Service` . If it's missing, see "Show the service's tray icon" above.
2. **Open its Status page** from that icon to see when each set of data last refreshed.
3. **If the Status page can't be opened or asked anything**, that's the password problem described above — it needs the decision, not troubleshooting.

This is a plain-language companion to `OPEN-TASKS.md` , which carries the same information with technical detail, evidence, and identifiers. Where the two disagree, `OPEN-TASKS.md` is authoritative.